Figure 3.9 An overview of a request to the `/person` URL for the extended ASP.NET Core minimal API application. The routing middleware routes the request to the correct lambda method. The endpoint generates a JSON response by executing the method and passes the response back through the middleware pipeline to the browser.

The trip has been pretty intense, but now you have a good overview of how an entire application is configured and how it handles a request by using minimal APIs. In chapter 4, you'll take a closer look at the middleware pipeline that exists in all ASP.NET Core applications. You'll learn how it's composed, how you can use it to add functionality to your application, and how you can use it to create simple HTTP services.

Summary

- The .csproj file contains the details of how to build your project, including which NuGet packages it depends on. Visual Studio and the .NET CLI use this file to build your application.
- Restoring the NuGet packages for an ASP.NET Core application downloads all your project's dependencies so that it can be built and run.
- Program.cs is where you define the code that runs when your app starts. You can create a `WebApplicationBuilder` by using `WebApplication.CreateBuilder()` and call methods on the builder to create your application.
- All services, both framework and custom application services, must be registered with the `WebApplicationBuilder` by means of the `Services` property, to be accessed later in your application.